WESTON (*annihilating her flippancy with one broadside*): Assassination!

LADY WESTON: Well, well! You always wanted to be a great man and now you have got your wish!

WESTON: What do you mean?

LADY WESTON: They don't assassinate nobodies.

WESTON (*showing her the paper*): Read that, and see if you can laugh.

LADY WESTON: I'm not laughing. (*Trying to read*): What a dreadful scrawl.

WESTON: Yes, the venomous scribbling of an illiterate.

LADY WESTON (*deciphering*): '***Remember Caesar***'. Is it a riddle?

WESTON: It is a death warrant. Do you know what day this is?

LADY WESTON: Thursday.

WESTON: What day of the month?

LADY WESTON: About the twelfth, I should guess.

WESTON (*with meaning*): It is the fifteenth. The fifteenth of March.

LADY WESTON: **Lawdamussy**! Your good sister's birthday! And we haven't sent her as much as a lily!

WESTON: I have deplored before, Frances, the incurable lightness of your mind. On the fifteenth of March, Caesar was murdered in the Forum.

LADY WESTON: Yes, of course, I remember. They couldn't stand his airs any longer.

WESTON (*reproving*): He was a great man.

LADY WESTON (*kindly*): Yes, my dear, I am sure he was. (*Looking again at the scrap of paper*) And is someone thinking of murdering you?

WESTON: Obviously.

LADY WESTON: I wonder someone hasn't done it long ago. (*Before the look of wonder can grow in his eye*) A great many people must hate judges. And you are a strict judge, they say.

WESTON: It is the law that is strict. I am a judge, my good Frances, not a juggler. I have never twisted the law to please the mob, and, I shall not please them by dying on the day of their choice.

LADY WESTON: No, of course not. You shall not go out of the house to-day. A nice light dinner and a good glass of –

WESTON: I have sent Roger to barricade all the doors, and I think it would be wise to close the ground floor shutters and see that they are not opened for any –

LADY WESTON: Is it the French and the Dutch together you are expecting! And this is the morning. Mr. Gammon's boy comes with the groceries. How am I to –

WESTON: My dear, is a little pepper more to you than your husband's life?

LADY WESTON: It isn't a little pepper, it's a great deal of flour. And you would be the first to complain if the bread were short, or the gravy thin. (*Giving him back the paper*) How do you know that the little paper was meant for you?

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